

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	03 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-3758
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

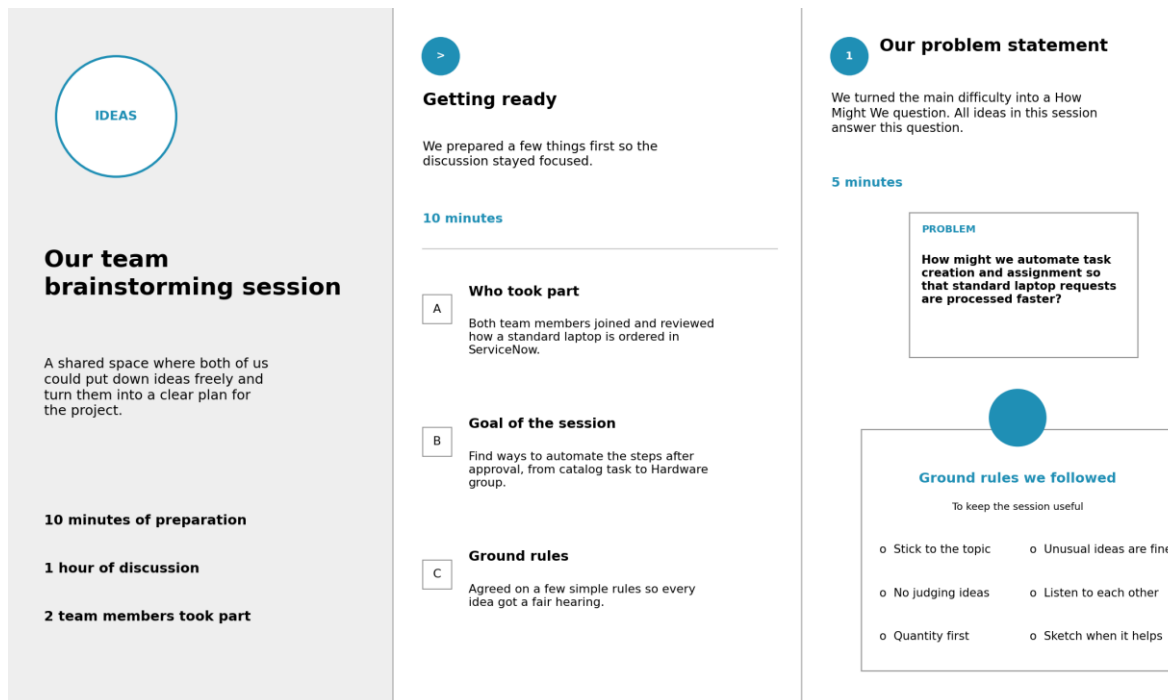
Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template:

In our brainstorming session, both team members shared ideas openly and did not judge each other's suggestions. We aimed to collect as many ideas as possible and built on each other's thoughts to find ways of simplifying how standard laptops are ordered and fulfilled in ServiceNow.

The session was carried out on a shared digital board so that every idea was recorded in one place. The steps below show how we selected our problem statement, listed and grouped our ideas, and ranked them by importance and feasibility.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/brainstorm-and-idea-prioritization>

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement



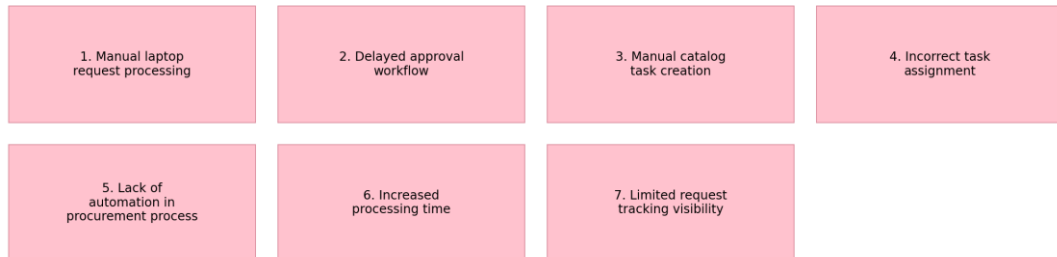
Identified Problems

1. Manual laptop request processing.
2. Delayed approval workflow.
3. Manual catalog task creation.

4. Incorrect task assignment.
5. Lack of automation in procurement process.
6. Increased processing time.
7. Limited request tracking visibility.

1 Problems we identified

Problems found in the current manual laptop ordering process, before choosing which to solve.



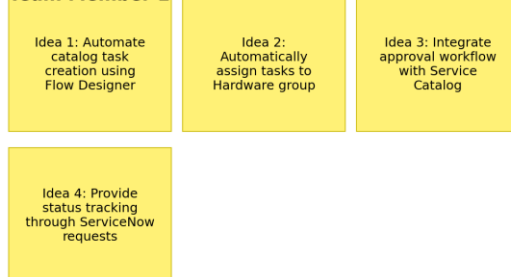
Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

2 Idea listing

Each member noted down ideas that could solve the laptop ordering problem.

10 minutes

Team Member 1



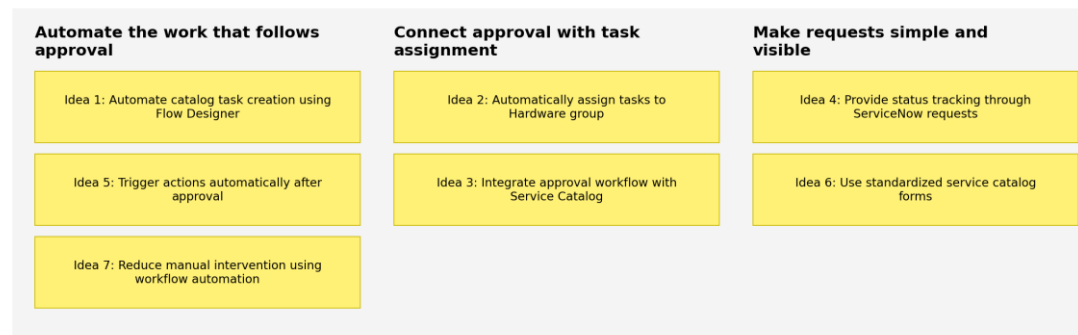
Team Member 2



3 Idea grouping

We read our notes aloud one by one, put similar notes together and gave each group a short label.

20 minutes



Ideas listed

1. Automate catalog task creation using Flow Designer.
2. Automatically assign tasks to Hardware group.
3. Integrate approval workflow with Service Catalog.
4. Provide status tracking through ServiceNow requests.
5. Trigger actions automatically after approval.

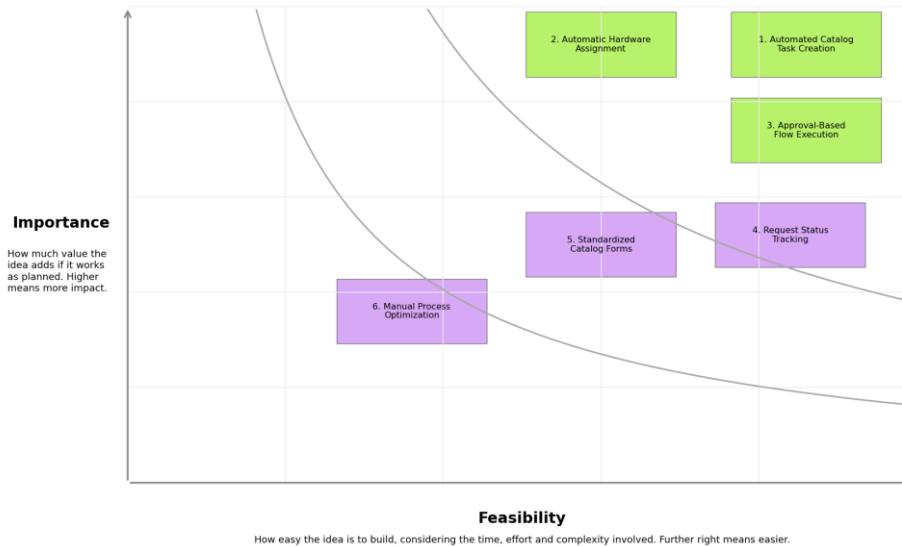
6. Use standardized service catalog forms.
7. Reduce manual intervention using workflow automation.

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

4 Ranking the ideas

We placed every idea on this grid so both of us could agree on which ones to build first, based on how valuable and how achievable they are.

20 minutes



Idea	Importance	Feasibility	Priority
Automated Catalog Task Creation	High	High	1
Automatic Hardware Assignment	High	High	2
Approval-Based Flow Execution	High	High	3
Request Status Tracking	Medium	High	4
Standardized Catalog Forms	Medium	High	5
Manual Process Optimization	Medium	Medium	6

Selected Solution: Automate the Standard Laptop Order process using ServiceNow Flow Designer, Service Catalog, Approval Workflow, and Automatic Catalog Task Assignment to the Hardware Team.

Ideation Phase

Define the Problem Statements

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Customer Problem Statement Template:

A problem statement describes a situation from the user's side. For our project, we wrote statements from the viewpoint of the two groups affected by manual laptop ordering: the employee who places the order and the IT hardware team who fulfils it.

Writing the problem in this form helped us understand the real difficulty behind the process and decide what needs to be automated before moving on to the solution in Flow Designer.

I am	Who is the user and what are they doing?	An employee requiring a standard laptop
I'm trying to	What outcome are they after?	Request a laptop quickly and efficiently
but	What gets in their way?	The process involves multiple manual steps
because	Why does that happen?	Task creation and assignment are performed manually
which makes me feel	How does it affect them emotionally?	Frustrated due to delays and lack of visibility

Reference: <https://miro.com/templates/customer-problem-statement/>

Example:

I am An IT administrator	I'm trying to Manage laptop requests efficiently	but Repetitive manual activities consume time	because There is no automated workflow for request fulfillment	which makes me feel Overloaded and less productive
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Problem Statement (PS)	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-1	An employee requiring a standard laptop	Request a laptop quickly and efficiently	The process involves multiple manual steps	Task creation and assignment are performed manually	Frustrated due to delays and lack of visibility

Problem Statement (PS)	I am (Customer)	I'm trying to	But	Because	Which makes me feel
PS-2	An IT administrator	Manage laptop requests efficiently	Repetitive manual activities consume time	There is no automated workflow for request fulfillment	Overloaded and less productive

Final Problem Statement

Employees and IT administrators face delays in the standard laptop procurement process due to manual approvals, manual task creation, and delayed assignment of requests. An automated workflow is required to improve efficiency, reduce manual effort, and provide faster service delivery.

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Empathize & Discover

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Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map shows what a user thinks, feels, hears, sees, says and does, along with their pains and gains. We used it to look at laptop ordering through the eyes of an employee who is waiting for a new laptop.

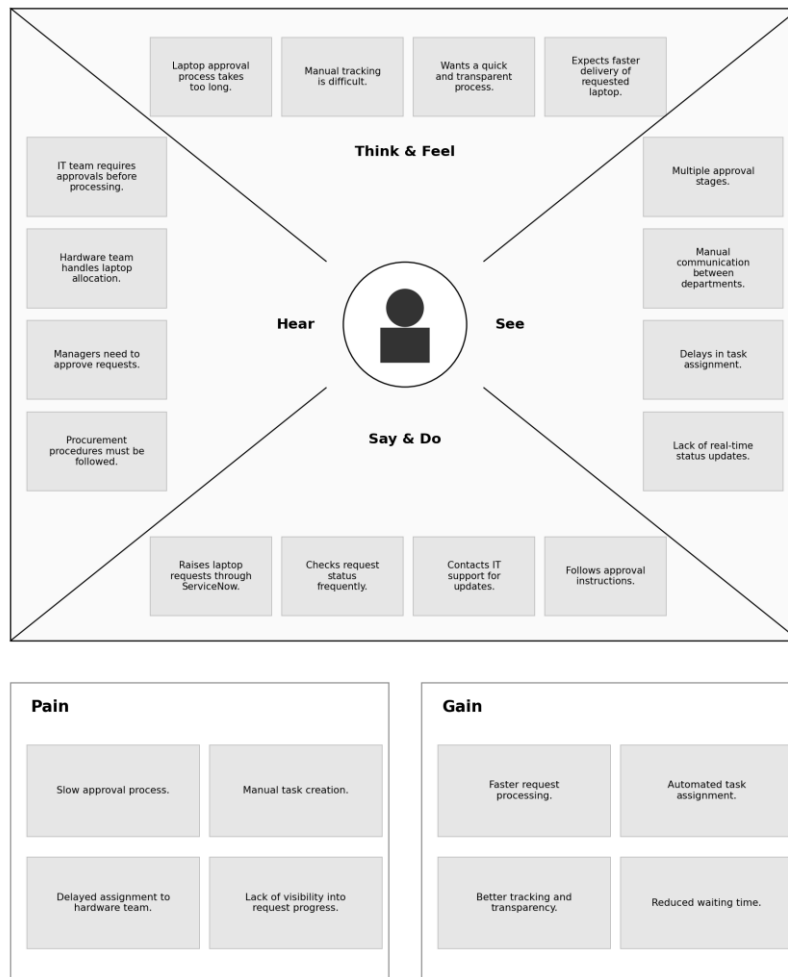
Mapping these points showed us where employees get stuck after their request is approved. This led directly to our idea of creating the catalog task and assigning it to the Hardware group automatically.

Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas>

Example: Standard Laptop Ordering in ServiceNow

User persona: Employee requesting a standard laptop through the IT department

Empathy Map



What does the user **THINK & FEEL**?

- Laptop approval process takes too long.
- Manual tracking is difficult.
- Wants a quick and transparent process.
- Expects faster delivery of requested laptop.

What does the user **SEE**?

- Multiple approval stages.
- Manual communication between departments.
- Delays in task assignment.
- Lack of real-time status updates.

What does the user **HEAR**?

- IT team requires approvals before processing.
- Hardware team handles laptop allocation.
- Managers need to approve requests.
- Procurement procedures must be followed.

What does the user **SAY & DO**?

- Raises laptop requests through ServiceNow.
- Checks request status frequently.
- Contacts IT support for updates.
- Follows approval instructions.

PAIN

- Slow approval process.
- Manual task creation.
- Delayed assignment to hardware team.
- Lack of visibility into request progress.

GAIN

- Faster request processing.
- Automated task assignment.
- Better tracking and transparency.
- Reduced waiting time.